Multicultural Britain: A Melting Pot or a Salad Bowl?

Target Audience: B1+ / B2 (Upper-Intermediate)
Time: 45-50 minutes
Approach: CLIL + Socio-cultural approach (Safonova's "Dialogue of Cultures")
Methodological Framework: TBL (Task-Based Learning) with elements of Guided Discovery.

Lesson Objectives:

- Educational (Content): Students will understand the concept of multiculturalism and the difference between the "melting pot" and "salad bowl" metaphors.
- Linguistic (Language): Students will practice vocabulary related to society and culture (e.g., *multiculturalism, assimilation, diversity, melting pot, salad bowl*) and develop reading and speaking skills.
- Socio-cultural (Safonova's approach): Students will develop cultural tolerance, analyze the challenges of integration, and compare the UK's multicultural experience with their own country's situation (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate background knowledge and introduce the core cultural concept.	5 min	Task 1: The "Food" question. Teacher asks: *"What is your favourite foreign food?"* (e.g., sushi, pizza, shawarma). Task 2: Teacher says: *"When you eat pizza in your country, do you eat it exactly like Italians do, or do you add your local ingredients? Imagine a country where different cultures mix. Do they blend into one, or stay separate like ingredients in a salad?"*	Pictures of different international foods.
Controlled Practice	Present target vocabulary and provide controlled practice to check	7 min	Task 1: Vocabulary Match. Students match words with definitions: *melting pot, salad bowl, assimilation, diversity*.	Vocabulary Match, presentation slide.

	understanding.		Task 2: Prediction. Students look at the title *"Multicultural Britain: A Melting Pot or a Salad Bowl?"* and guess which metaphor describes modern Britain.	
Pre-Reading	Set the purpose for reading the text.	3 min	Teacher asks: *"Let's read to find out which metaphor (melting pot or salad bowl) the British prefer today."* Students have 1 minute to skim the text.	Presentation, worksheet BBC News | UK | Should the UK model itself on America? , Melting Pots, Salad Bowls and Kaleidoscopes: Unpacking Metap | St Edmund Hall , multiculturalism | LearnEnglish Teens
Reading	Develop reading skills for detailed understanding of multiculturalism in the UK.	10 min	Students read the text carefully and answer the comprehension questions. Then they find examples of the "salad bowl" concept in the text.	Text, presentation
Post-Reading (Freer Practice)	Apply knowledge, develop critical thinking through the "Dialogue of Cultures".	15 min	Task 1: Role-Play "City Council Meeting".Group work. Students are members of a city council. They must decide how to spend a budget to help immigrants integrate into the community while preserving their own culture. (e.g., build a community center, organize a food festival, provide English classes). Task 2: Dialogue of Cultures. Discuss: *"Is your country a melting pot or a salad bowl? What are the benefits and challenges of*	Council template, board for comparison.

			multiculturalism?"	
Homework and feedback	Summarize, consolidate, and reflect on cultural importance.	5 min	Reflection: *"Why is it important to respect other cultures while living in one society?"* Homework: Write a short essay (100 words): *"What does it mean to be a citizen of a multicultural country?"*	Board, students' notebooks.

Task 2: **Key Vocabulary**

Match the words (1-4) with their definitions (A-D). Write the correct letter in the box.

Word	**Letter**	**Definition**
1. Melting pot	[ ]	A. The process of becoming part of a new culture and losing your old cultural identity.
2. Salad bowl	[ ]	B. A metaphor for a society where different cultures mix together and create one new, blended culture.
3. Assimilation	[ ]	C. A metaphor for a society where different cultures live together but keep their own unique traditions and identities.
4. Diversity	[ ]	D. The state of having a lot of variety (different people, cultures, ideas).

Task 2: answers

1. B
2. C
3. A
4. D

Multicultural Britain: A Melting Pot or a Salad Bowl?
(Adapted from BBC Bitesize and British Council educational materials)

For centuries, people from all over the world have moved to the United Kingdom. Today, the UK is a very diverse society. However, there are different ways to understand how immigrants fit into the country.

Historically, the United States used the metaphor of the "melting pot". This meant that immigrants from different countries should assimilate—they should mix together to create one new, unified American culture. They were expected to leave their old traditions behind.

However, many modern countries, including the UK, prefer the metaphor of the "salad bowl"(sometimes called a "cultural mosaic"). Think about a salad: the lettuce, tomatoes, and cucumbers are all in the same bowl, but they don't lose their individual taste or shape. In a "salad bowl" society, people from different backgrounds live together and contribute to society, but they are free to keep their own languages, religions, and traditions.

In the UK today, you can see this "salad bowl" everywhere. It is in the food (Chicken Tikka Masala is now a British national dish), in the languages spoken on the streets of London (over 300 languages are spoken in the city), and in popular music.

Of course, living in a diverse society is not always easy. It can sometimes lead to cultural misunderstandings or conflicts. But the general idea of a "salad bowl" is that diversity makes a society stronger and more interesting, not weaker.

Task 1: Read the text and answer the questions.

1. What did the "melting pot" metaphor mean historically in the USA?
   _____
2. How is a "salad bowl" different from a "melting pot"?
   _____
3. _____
4. Name two examples from the text that show the UK is a "salad bowl" society today.
   _____

Task 2: Find the Words.
Find the word in the text that means: *"to become part of a group or culture, often losing your original identity."*
Answer: _____

Role-Play "City Council Meeting"

Situation: You are members of the city council in a diverse British city. You have a budget of £10,000 to promote multiculturalism. Discuss in groups and choose only 3 projects from the list to fund. Be ready to explain your choice.

Project Ideas:

1. "Welcome Centre": Free English language classes for immigrants.
2. "World Food Festival": A big street party where everyone shares their national dishes.
3. "Cultural Heritage Museum": A museum that showcases the history of the different communities in the city.
4. "Integration Sports Club": A football club where local British people and immigrants play together.
5. "Mother Tongue School": A school where children of immigrants can learn their parents' native language.

Our Group's Choice:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Why we chose these projects (Explain):

_____
_____
_____
_____

TASK 4: Dialogue of Cultures (Discussion)

Discuss the questions in pairs or small groups:

1. Is your country a "melting pot" or a "salad bowl"? Give examples.
2. What are the main challenges of living in a multicultural society?
3. How can we avoid cultural conflicts?

_____

HOMEWORK

Write a short essay (100-120 words).
Topic: "What does it mean to be a citizen of a multicultural country?"